



Photographs by AL SEIB For The Times

NURSE Lindsay Brant in the cardiothoracic ICU at Ronald Reagan UCLA Medical Center, where she introduced an initiative to support patients, families and staff through the dying process.

COLUMN ONE

This ICU lends a hand helping patients and staff live with dying

When there’s nothing left to fix, honoring death can be life-affirming



“THE DYING process is part of humanity, and therefore the process itself needs to be respected,” Brant explained.

BY CORINNE PURTILL

Extraordinary things happen in the cardiothoracic intensive care unit at Ronald Reagan UCLA Medical Center. The sick rise from bed with new hearts and lungs. Machines valiantly take over for faltering kidneys, heart valves, bronchial tubes. All patients enter with grave health concerns, and the vast majority leave recovered, or at least on the road to healing. The unit has 150 nurses, at least two dozen of whom are on the floor at any time. They are there for all of it: every intubation and needle stick, every setback, every odds-defying rebound. They bond with their patients and advocate hard for their best interests. “Our business is living, surviving and getting

UC drops a diversity hiring requirement

Amid pressure from Trump, job applicants won’t be asked to submit testimonials.

BY JAWEED KALEEM

University of California leaders are eliminating a years-old practice of requiring faculty job applicants to submit “diversity statements,” a move that comes after the Trump administration threatened to revoke federal funding from schools and universities that maintain diversity, equity and inclusion programs. As part of job applications or promotions, many departments at UC campuses have asked job seekers to submit written testimonials of one or two pages about how they have worked to enhance and support racial and other kinds of diversity in their fields. The essay requests started to appear in some UC applications in the early 2000s and gained popularity in the 2010s, attracting both praise and controversy as UC became a national leader in the practice. UC regents announced the decision Wednesday evening after their first meeting, held at UCLA, since the federal government launched a series of investigations at UC and other U.S. campuses over allegations that they discriminate against white, Asian American and Jewish employees and students. “The requirement to submit a diversity statement may lead applicants to focus on an aspect of their candidacy that is outside their expertise or prior experience,” Katherine S. Newman, UC provost and execu-

tive vice president for academic affairs, said in a Wednesday letter to campus provosts. “The regents stated that our values and commitment to our mission have not changed,” the letter said. “We can continue to effectively serve our communities from a variety of life experiences, backgrounds, and points of view without requiring diversity statements.” She added that although stand-alone diversity statements in hiring will “no longer be permitted,” faculty are still allowed to optionally share any “inclusive aca-

[See UC, A6]

Trump orders Dept. of Education to shut

Even before his executive action, changes in California have been substantial.

BY HOWARD BLUME, JENNY GOLD, JAWEED KALEEM AND DANIEL MILLER

President Trump on Thursday signed an executive order to dismantle the Department of Education, a long-anticipated action that will affect how billions of dollars in federal funding for California will be distributed to millions of students, educators and institutions. “We’re going to shut it down and shut it down as quickly as possible,” Trump said at a White House event to celebrate his executive order. “It’s doing us no good. We want to return our students to the states.” Trump pledged that vital mandated programs — Pell Grants for low-income college students, and Title I funding that serves students from disadvantaged families and programs for students with disabilities — would continue without interruption under the management of other agencies. The dismantling of the department has been unofficially in progress for weeks but would require the approval of Congress to fully shut down. Yet Trump’s impact on education already has been substantial in California. The administration yanked federal funding from entities

[See Education, A6]

Hollywood producers aim to define, improve role

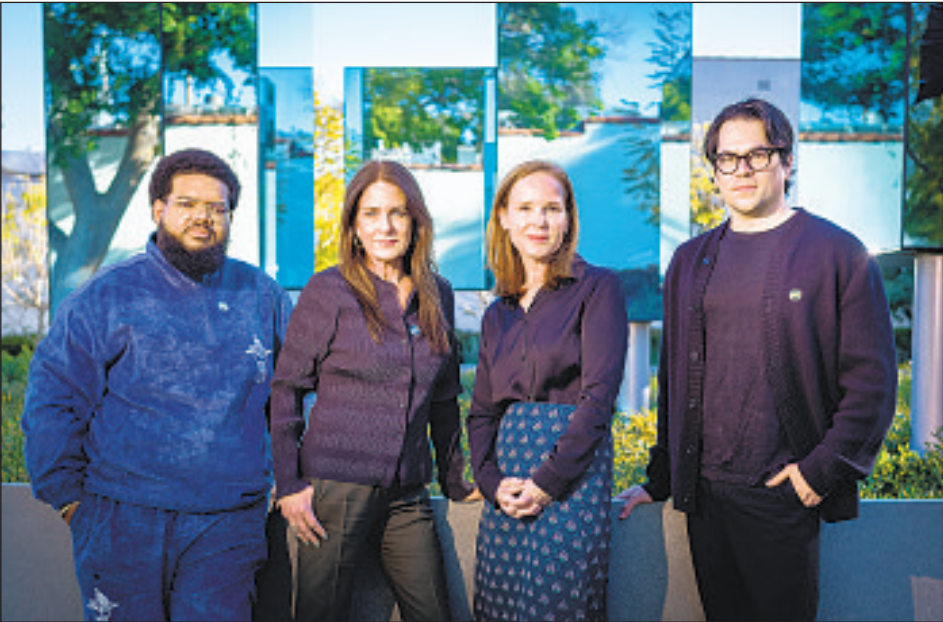
Amid credit inflation, they want pay for development time, healthcare and more.

BY SAMANTHA MASUNAGA

After years of hustle, film and TV producer Stephen Love found himself in a situation many of his peers would salivate over: He was in four bidding wars. Studios clamored to snap up his projects. Hollywood trade news outlets gushed about their merits, bolstering Love’s career and reputation. But all the while, Love was shooting commercials and music videos and trying to get consulting gigs to make ends meet. He even drove for ride-share companies.

The son of a preacher and a teacher, Love, 35, grew up on a farm in York, S.C., almost 40 miles south of Charlotte, N.C. He’s come a long way from when he caught the film bug in his youth, which led him to start a videography business while still in school to shoot weddings and other occasions. But even after the bidding wars, Love, who produced the 2016 drama “The Land” and 2023 sci-fi film “They Cloned Tyrone,” has multiple jobs. He consults on the side while running a company that makes commercials and music videos and working on branded content and deals. He’s far from the only one. “You have to have these multiple things happening while you’re also trying to fo-

[See Producers, A9]



DAVID BUTOW For The Times

PRODUCERS United — members include Stephen Love, left, Cathy Schulman, Jennifer Todd and Jonathan Wang — seeks to get producers paid as they work.

Trump’s ideology reshapes Taiwan relations

BY STEPHANIE YANG AND XIN-YUN WU

TAIPEI, Taiwan — For decades, the U.S. has played an important role in maintaining the delicate relationship between Taiwan and China, which considers Taiwan to be a part of its territory and has vowed to pursue unification by force, if necessary. But President Trump’s “America first”

ideology and use of tariffs as an economic weapon suggest the administration may be rewriting the rules of the U.S.-China-Taiwan playbook to suit his transactional style. As is true in much of the world, long-held understandings, meant to preserve peace, are suddenly up for negotiation. Although the U.S. does not recognize Taiwan as an independent nation, it has been contrac-

tually obligated to support the island’s defense program with weapons sales for years. It’s part of an official policy known as “strategic ambiguity,” intended to deter China from launching an attack and Taiwan from formally declaring independence. Trump has not said whether the U.S. will defend Taiwan in the future, but he has complained about the relationship, and his admin-

istration has said that the island should raise its defense budget to 10% of its gross domestic product. The president has also criticized Taiwan’s cutting-edge semiconductor industry for “stealing” U.S. business and threatened tariffs on Taiwanese chips. Then, on March 3, he announced a \$100-billion investment from Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co., or

[See Taiwan, A4]

Online coverage of UCLA’s matchup

For a full report of the Bruins’ NCAA tournament game against Utah State, go to latimes.com/sports.

Records request prompts lawsuit

L.A. County sheriff sues panel over subpoenas about deputy misconduct. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 76/51. **B6**

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Delta courts upscale clientele

Luxury lounge at LAX boasts massage chairs and caviar-topped ice cream. **BUSINESS, A8**

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